Unit 3

Chromatic Notes

New: Chromatic passing and neighbour notes, V7 of V, the melodic minor

A chromatic note is a note outside the key: a sharp, flat or natural that is not in the key signature. In this unit they come in three ways: as quick passing and neighbour notes in the tune, as the raised 4th of a chord that leads to V (V7 of V), and as the raised 6th and 7th of the melodic minor scale.

What is new

An accidental lasts to the bar line

A sharp, flat or natural applies to every later note on the same line or space until the end of the bar. The next bar is back to the key signature. A reminder in the next bar (a 'courtesy' accidental) is only there to help you.

Chromatic passing notes

Between two notes a whole step apart, the tune can slip through the half step in between: C C-sharp D going up, E E-flat D going down. They are short and fall between the beats.

Chromatic neighbours

A note can dip to the half step below and come back: E D-sharp E.

V7 of V

In C major the chord D F-sharp A C leads strongly to G (V). Its F-sharp is the raised 4th of the key; in G major it is C-sharp, in F major B-natural. After it, the natural sign cancels it again.

The melodic minor

Going up to the tonic, minor tunes often raise the 6th and the 7th (in A minor F-sharp and G-sharp); coming down they use the natural notes of the key signature (G and F).

Chromatic passing and neighbour notes

C C-sharp D (passing, going up), E E-flat D (passing, going down), E D-sharp E (neighbour). The sharp in bar 1 does not carry into bar 2.



V7 of V in C major, then V and I

D F-sharp A C leads to G B D F, then to C. In V7 the natural sign cancels the F-sharp.



A melodic minor, up and down

Up: F-sharp and G-sharp. Down: G and F, as in the key signature.



Reading tips

1. Scan for accidentals before you play, and decide which notes they change for the rest of the bar.

2. A chromatic passing note always moves on in the same direction by a half step: let your finger slide.

3. In minor keys, expect the raised 7th whenever the music leans towards the tonic.

4. After a bar full of sharps, check the next bar: the key signature is back.

Part A: Chromatic passing and neighbour notes

♩ = 66

C, G and F major: chromatic passing notes (between two notes a whole step apart) and lower neighbours, always on the second half of a beat.

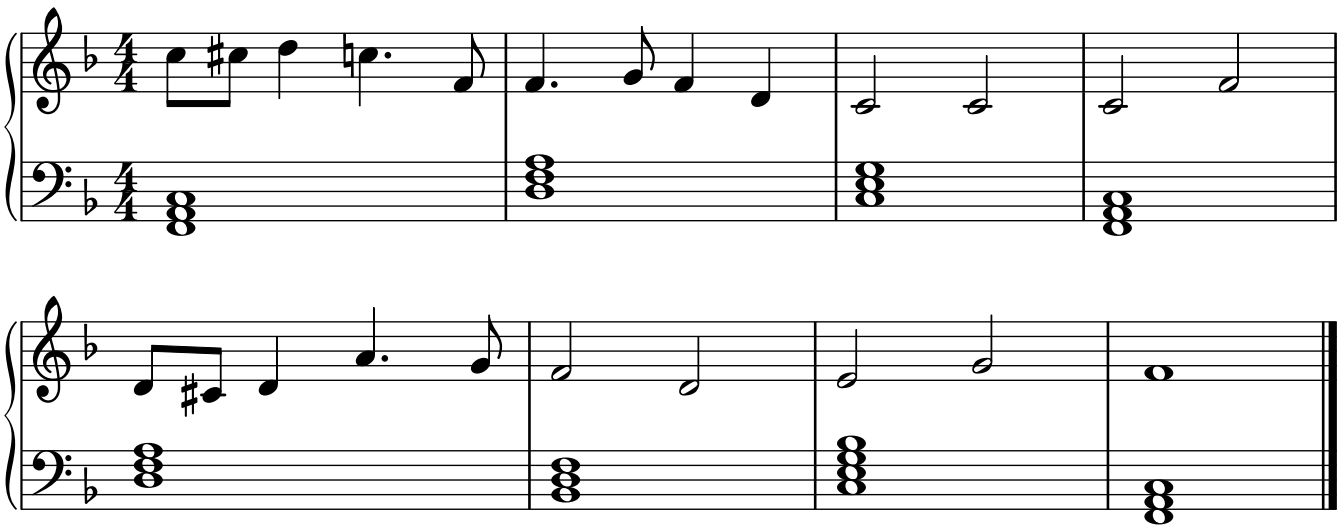
☐ **3.1**



☐ **3.2**



☐ **3.3**



3.4



3.5



3.6



3.7



3.8



Part B: V7 of V: the raised 4th ♩= 72

V7 of V comes before V: listen for F-sharp in C major, C-sharp in G major and B-natural in F major.

☐ **3.9**



☐ **3.10**



☐ **3.11**



☐ **3.12**



☐ **3.13**



☐ **3.14**



3.15



3.16



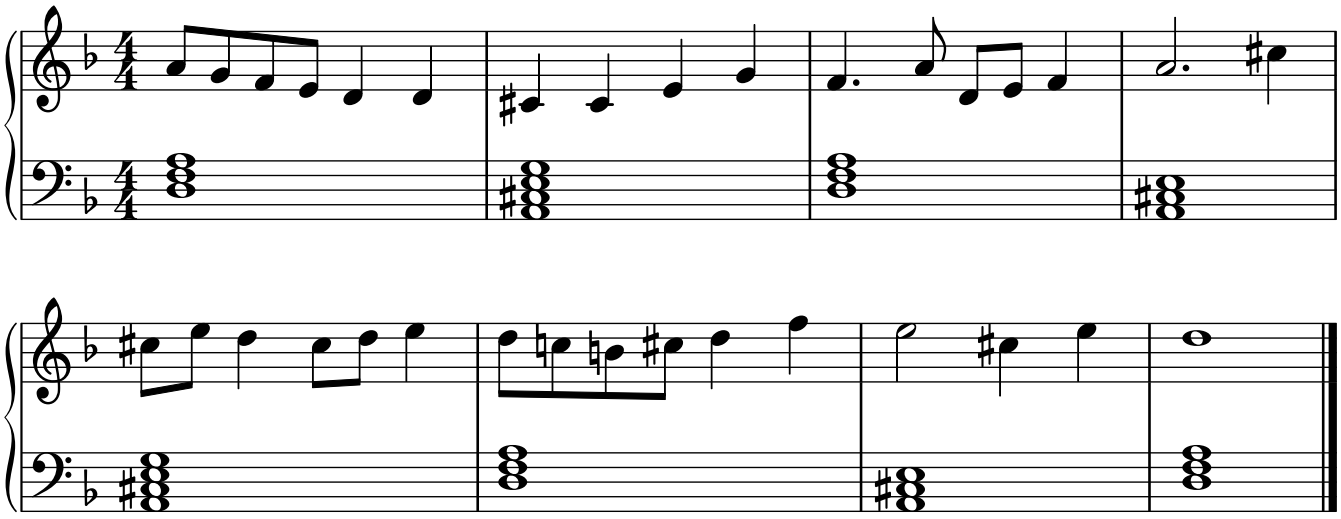
Part C: The melodic minor ♩= 66

A, D and E minor with the melodic minor: raised 6th and 7th going up, natural notes coming down.

☐ **3.17**



☐ **3.18**



☐ **3.19**



☐ **3.20**



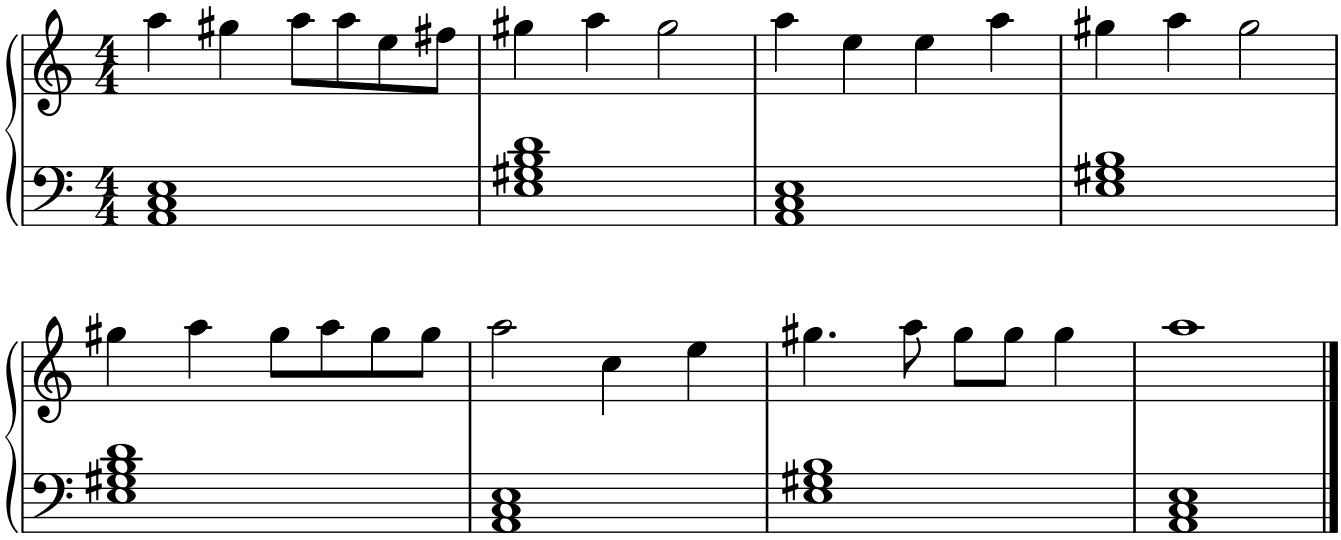
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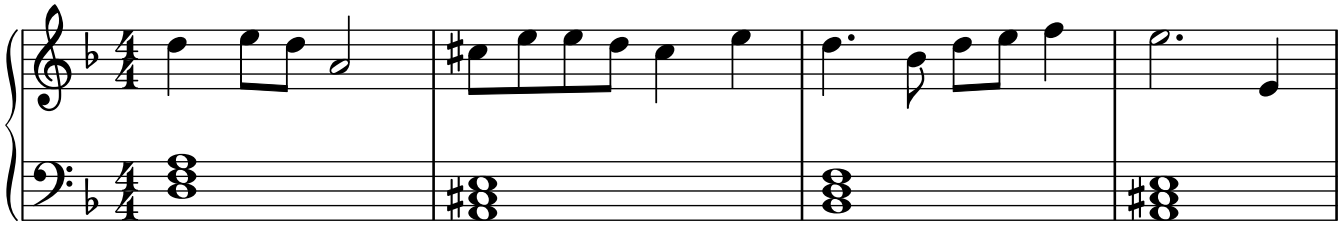
☐ **3.22**



☐ **3.23**



☐ **3.24**





Pieces

Pieces are for playing more than once. Read each one first without stopping, like an exercise; then practise it until it sounds steady and musical.

Chromatic Walk ♩ = 76

Original

D-sharp and C-sharp are chromatic neighbour and passing notes. In bars 3 and 7, V7 of V brings F-sharp into both hands; the natural sign on F in bar 7 cancels it.



Up the Melodic Minor ♩ = 72

Original

Going up (bars 2 and 6) the tune uses F-sharp and G-sharp; coming down (bar 3) it uses G and F from the key signature. The left hand's G-sharp belongs to the E major chord (V).



First Loss ♩= 66

Robert Schumann (1848), Album for the Young, Op. 68 No. 16 - first part

D-sharp is the raised 7th of E minor; the left hand climbs chromatically A, A-sharp, B in bars 6, 7 and 14-15. The left hand moves into the treble clef for its off-beat chords and back into the bass clef (watch the clef signs: Unit 7 is about them). Play the whole passage twice. Notes retyped from the Mutopia Project engraving no. 676 by Philippe Hezaine (CC BY-SA 2.5).



Poor Orphan ♩= 60

Robert Schumann (1848), Album for the Young, Op. 68 No. 6 - first part

Two voices in each hand. G-sharp, the raised 7th, is in the right hand; in bar 2 the left hand has G-natural (the natural minor). The tune in bars 3-4 and 7-8 is in the left hand, which moves into the treble clef. In bar 2 the F is a thirty-second note: very short, just before the beat. Play the passage twice. Notes retyped from the Mutopia Project engraving no. 687 by Philippe Hezaine (CC BY-SA 2.5).



Checkpoint: ready for Unit 4?

- Play two new exercises from each part at the speeds shown, with no more than one stop each.
- Pass if every accidental is right, including notes later in the same bar, and the key signature returns in the next bar.
- Pass if you can play Chromatic Walk and Up the Melodic Minor at sight, and First Loss after a few days.
- When you pass, move on to Unit 4.